

September

22

1762

Russian coronation

After seizing power from her husband, Catherine II was crowned empress of Russia at a grand ceremony in Moscow.

Catherine the Great ruled for 34 years, expanding her empire so that it became the largest in the world.



Born this day

1791 Michael Faraday, British scientist. He discovered how electrical currents could be created using magnets, and invented the electric motor.

World Car-Free Day

To draw attention to the impact of cars on the environment, people in more than 700 cities across the world cycled, walked, or took public transport instead of driving their cars on the first World Car-Free Day.

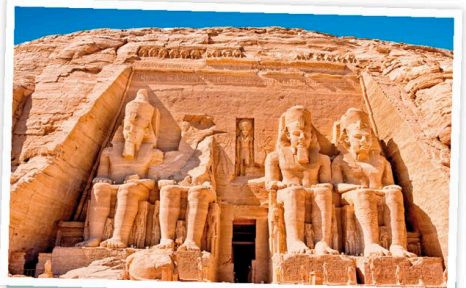
2000



1968

Abu Simbel

A UNESCO-led team of engineers completed reassembling the massive Abu Simbel temple in Egypt. It was raised 64 m (210 ft) above its original location to save it from the waters of the human-made Lake Nasser.



Also on this day

1948 US pilot Gail Halvorsen made his first flight to drop bundles of sweets in tiny parachutes made from handkerchiefs over West Berlin after being given permission by the US Air Force. The packages were meant for children affected by the Berlin Blockade that had been put in place by the Soviet Union.

1991 Photographs of the Dead Sea Scrolls, religious manuscripts dating to Biblical times, were made public for the first time.